

Plutarch/Government

U.S.





About the Course

Students study a life by Plutarch for two terms and then spend the rest of the year exploring topics of government through historical documents and decisions from this rotation.

This topic is included in the following course(s): Citizenship: Grade 9 (U.S.)



Placement & Combining Tips

Plutarch lessons are shared with Grades 6-8, and the final term of government lessons is shared with Grades 10-11, and are also suitable for inquisitive 8th graders.



Scheduling

GRADE	SCHEDULE INFO.	BOOKS
9	Plutarch/Government: Grade 9 (U.S.) 1 time/week 30 min	The Plutarch Project Volume Three (Revised) Reading PDF

Sample Weekly View

Day 1	Day 2	Day 3	Day 4	Day 5
Citizenship: Grade 9 (U.S.)				
Ethics: Part 3 Community Read Alouds: Grades 1-12				Plutarch/Government: Grade 9 (U.S.) Current Events: Grades 9-12



Planning & Prep

Permission to print for non-commercial use. See Alveary group use policy to use lessons in a group context.

LINKS: Click text or scan the QR code in the top corner of the lesson plan pages to view online resources associated with the lessons.

Responsibility for previewing all links rests with the teacher. All links were checked at the time of publication; however, websites change frequently and may contain objectionable content. Please report broken links by contacting us through our website.



Books & Resources

For book rationales and purchase options, click the Book List link or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Book List Details](#)



The Plutarch Project Volume Three (Revised)



Reading PDF



Supplies

For supply list details and basic supplies helpful to have on hand, click the links or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Basic Supplies](#)

(No Subject Supplies Assigned)



Quick Links

(No Quick Links Assigned)

[Click THIS text
or scan the QR
code for links.](#)



Plutarch/Government: Grade 9 (U.S.)

How To Approach



Prepare

Teachers may find it helpful to pre-read all or part of the selection from Plutarch studied and choose which news sites to offer students.

If you, the student, are learning at home, work to schedule a time with your teacher when you can complete the lessons from Ourselves and Plutarch together, as these lessons are much richer when shared and discussed.



Recap

Connect back to the previous lesson. (Optional for Current Events).



Introduce

For news sources: Scan the headlines first to get an overview, and then choose a story to read.

For Citizenship books (optional): Use a picture, a map, or an engaging question to get yourselves interested in the lesson. If necessary, you may talk about one or two unfamiliar words that will be crucial to understanding. It is not necessary to cover all unfamiliar words.



Read

Read the selection assigned or the news story chosen. For rich, dense, or more challenging books such as Ourselves and Plutarch, it is a good idea to read them aloud. Have students keep an eye out for things to add to their Citizenship Notebook, Book of Centuries, and/or Commonplace book.



Narrate

Narrate orally or in writing.



Discuss

Share your thoughts on the story and any connections made. For current events, look up where events occurred on a map and ask questions together to discern the quality of the piece. (e.g., Are there sources cited? Is there an obvious bias? If so, what do other authors have to say on this subject? Are arguments supported by evidence? Is that evidence credible?) Consider reading an alternative perspective.



Citizenship Notebook

Record important ideas in your Citizenship Notebooks. Make a calendar of current events.

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Term 1		
WEEK 1	☐ 30m Plutarch/Government: Grade 9 (U.S.) - Lesson 1	
WEEK 2	☐ 30m Plutarch/Government: Grade 9 (U.S.) - Lesson 2	
WEEK 3	☐ 30m Plutarch/Government: Grade 9 (U.S.) - Lesson 3	
WEEK 4	☐ 30m Plutarch/Government: Grade 9 (U.S.) - Lesson 4	
WEEK 5	☐ 30m Plutarch/Government: Grade 9 (U.S.) - Lesson 5	
WEEK 6	☐ 30m Plutarch/Government: Grade 9 (U.S.) - Lesson 6	
WEEK 7	☐ 30m Plutarch/Government: Grade 9 (U.S.) - Lesson 7	
WEEK 8	☐ 30m Plutarch/Government: Grade 9 (U.S.) - Lesson 8	
WEEK 9	☐ 30m Plutarch/Government: Grade 9 (U.S.) - Lesson 9	
WEEK 10	☐ 30m Plutarch/Government: Grade 9 (U.S.) - Lesson 10	
WEEK 11	☐ 30m Plutarch/Government: Grade 9 (U.S.) - Lesson 11	
WEEK 12	☐ 30m Plutarch/Government: Grade 9 (U.S.) - Lesson 12	

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Term 2		
WEEK 1	☐ 30m Plutarch/Government: Grade 9 (U.S.) - Lesson 13	
WEEK 2	☐ 30m Plutarch/Government: Grade 9 (U.S.) - Lesson 14	
WEEK 3	☐ 30m Plutarch/Government: Grade 9 (U.S.) - Lesson 15	
WEEK 4	☐ 30m Plutarch/Government: Grade 9 (U.S.) - Lesson 16	
WEEK 5	☐ 30m Plutarch/Government: Grade 9 (U.S.) - Lesson 17	
WEEK 6	☐ 30m Plutarch/Government: Grade 9 (U.S.) - Lesson 18	
WEEK 7	☐ 30m Plutarch/Government: Grade 9 (U.S.) - Lesson 19	
WEEK 8	☐ 30m Plutarch/Government: Grade 9 (U.S.) - Lesson 20	
WEEK 9	☐ 30m Plutarch/Government: Grade 9 (U.S.) - Lesson 21	
WEEK 10	☐ 30m Plutarch/Government: Grade 9 (U.S.) - Lesson 22	
WEEK 11	☐ 30m Plutarch/Government: Grade 9 (U.S.) - Lesson 23	
WEEK 12	☐ 30m Plutarch/Government: Grade 9 (U.S.) - Lesson 24	

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Term 3		
WEEK 1	☐ 30m Plutarch/Government: Grade 9 (U.S.) - Lesson 25	
WEEK 2	☐ 30m Plutarch/Government: Grade 9 (U.S.) - Lesson 26	
WEEK 3	☐ 30m Plutarch/Government: Grade 9 (U.S.) - Lesson 27	
WEEK 4	☐ 30m Plutarch/Government: Grade 9 (U.S.) - Lesson 28	
WEEK 5	☐ 30m Plutarch/Government: Grade 9 (U.S.) - Lesson 29	
WEEK 6	☐ 30m Plutarch/Government: Grade 9 (U.S.) - Lesson 30	
WEEK 7	☐ 30m Plutarch/Government: Grade 9 (U.S.) - Lesson 31	
WEEK 8	☐ 30m Plutarch/Government: Grade 9 (U.S.) - Lesson 32	
WEEK 9	☐ 30m Plutarch/Government: Grade 9 (U.S.) - Lesson 33	
WEEK 10	☐ 30m Plutarch/Government: Grade 9 (U.S.) - Lesson 34	
WEEK 11	☐ 30m Plutarch/Government: Grade 9 (U.S.) - Lesson 35	
WEEK 12	☐ 30m Plutarch/Government: Grade 9 (U.S.) - Lesson 36	

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Examination

Term 1

- Tell me everything you remember about the life of Julius Caesar.
- You are a Roman citizen who lived through all of it. Caesar was on the wrong side as a young man, nearly drowned escaping, nearly starved at Pharsalus, made himself dictator for life, died in the Senate chamber, and was declared a god three days later. The city burned. The men who killed him were hunted to their deaths. Now it is quiet. Was Rome better or worse for having had him? Why?
- You are someone who admired Caesar deeply and also someone who could see clearly what he was becoming. Those two things were both true at the same time for most of the people closest to him. Think about a person in your own life, or a figure in history, or a character from a story, in whom you can see greatness and destructive behavior running alongside each other. What do you do with admiration that you cannot separate from concern?
- You have followed Caesar from his early campaigns through every battle, every crisis, every triumph, and into Rome at the end. You have watched him grab sailors, swim through fire, feed horses seaweed, pardon enemies, refuse bodyguards, and finally cover his face and stop when he saw Brutus. Looking at the whole of what you witnessed: what did this man actually want, and did he ever get it?

Term 2

- Tell me everything you remember about the lives of Agis and Cleomenes.
- You have watched Agesilaus, Agis's own uncle, embrace the reform publicly, help burn the debt bonds in the marketplace, laugh at the "brightest fire" he had ever seen, and then delay the land division once, and again, and again, until the moment was lost and Leonidas came back and Agis was killed in prison. Agesilaus was not a tyrant. He was not an enemy of Sparta. He was a debtor who did not want to pay. What do you think about his behavior?
- You are a Spartan woman. You watched Agesistrata and Archidamia killed in the same prison where Agis died. You watched Cratesiclea sail to Egypt as a hostage, forcing back her tears at the temple door so her son would not see her break. You watched Agiatis, widow of a murdered king, keep her husband's dream alive and pass it on to the man she was forced to marry. You watched Chilonis choose grief twice instead of safety once. The city is quiet now. Antigonos came and went without burning anything down. Was what these women carried worth what it cost them?

Term 3

- Tell me everything you remember about the lives of the Gracchi.
- The brothers were nothing alike, and everything alike. Tiberius was gentle and restrained. Gaius was fiery. Think of a time when you had to choose between patience and urgency, when both paths seemed right, but for different reasons. Which did you choose? What happened? Which brother do you think you are more like, and which one do you think you should try to be?
- You have followed the Gracchi from Cornelia's house through every assembly, every law, every riot, and into the silence after. You watched Tiberius weep before his father's statue on the last morning of his life and keep walking. You watched Gaius pull his hand quietly from his wife's grip at the door and not look back. You watched Cornelia lose both sons and go on hosting dinner parties for learned men without shedding a tear. What do you think about their behavior? Is there a right way to face grief, loss and fear?